20 Using a small skew chisel turn a taper making sure that the thin end of the taper becomes smaller than 4mm. Sand the stem gently with 240 grit abrasive and polish with a friction polish or just add a coat of sanding sealer to darken the wood before parting off with the skew

21 Attaching a sanding disc, here you can see I've secured a piece of ply to a faceplate ring which in turn connects to the jaws on my chuck. Taper the back of the ply disc and stick on hook backing so you can use hook-and-loop backed abrasive discs

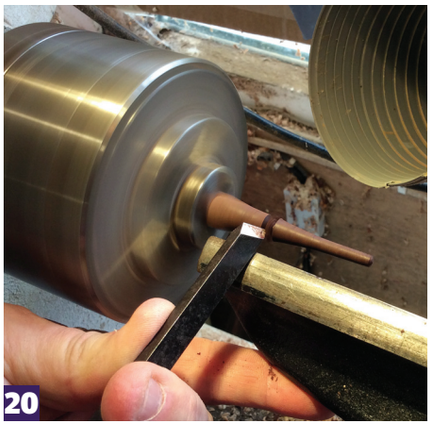
22 Sand one side of the freshly turned stem to give the impression that the stem is bent

23 The stem will now push fit into the piece of fruit ready to be glued in at a later stage

24 Here you can see the clove placed into the bottom of the piece of fruit looking really realistic and adding a great finishing touch

25 The finished fruit with their stems and cloves glued on

26 Here the fruit now have their labels attached giving the names of the timber which you should recognise as mulberry (*Morus spp.*), acacia (*Umbellularia californica*), padauk, yew (*Taxus baccata*), spalted beech and laburnum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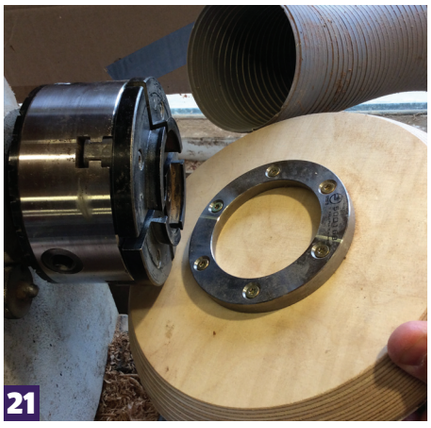
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HANDY HINTS

1. Use a sawtooth bit when cutting end grain and a Forstner bit for cutting side grain. You will end up with cleaner cuts. The Forstner bit has no teeth on the upper cutting rim edge and thereby gives a cleaner, more precise, cut in side grain. However, it is a bit slower than a saw-tooth bit in cutting the wood
2. Choose bright, colourful and interesting grained timbers for making fruit. They will always be the first to sell
3. Choose a soft timber with a light grain for making your chucks and avoid timber such as ash, chestnut (*castanea sativa*) and pines (*Pinus spp*) which are known to split easily
4. When drilling use wax polish as a lubricant if you need to. However, don't use too much or you run the risk of cross-contaminating the work
5. Keep a separate jar of sanding sealer for timbers like padauk as the sealer will get contaminated with the colour and start leaving orange streaks on paler timbers

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